

Chapter 89_2 - Demon Lord (Continued)

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On the Mid-Autumn Festival, every household lit their lamps, eating moon cakes¹ and admiring the full moon. But Ning Fuyi's group turned their backs on such family joy in the mortal world and came to the Western Wasteland, where few people set foot.

Bai Lin, who had led them here, shrank down and entered the Mind Pearl. The three of them descended from high above. Ning Fuyi wore black robes, her ink-black hair bound up with a black hairpin. Though her cheeks were pale, the three parts evil within them made her more like a ghost or demon, showing no human mercy.

Nine Infants still wore her dark red clothes. She was already born bewitching, so she also matched the vast desert beneath their feet. Only Baili Shiqi, who was obviously from an immortal sect, looked completely out of place.

"Shiqi." Ning Fuyi looked at her. "I owe you much for this journey. You saved me from Penglai and escorted us here. Such great kindness cannot be repaid with words."

"What great kindness is there?" Baili Shiqi swayed her braids. "This is the chivalry of the martial world—I should act this way!"

"Moreover, moreover, I just like Sister Ning. I think you're incredibly amazing."

Ning Fuyi smiled.

She turned to look at the endless sand and dust and the stretching sand mountains, saying softly: "But you are ultimately a Penglai person. Wherever you go, you would be revered by people. This Demon Realm is dark and treacherous—it's not suitable for you."

"But..." Hearing this, Baili Shiqi wanted to argue but was interrupted by Ning Fuyi.

"I've already harmed too many people. I don't want to drag you down with me anymore. From now on, once I step into this Demon Realm, I'll become a demon despised by all living beings. If you follow me, you'll never be able to wander the martial world and act righteously again." Ning Fuyi's words brooked no argument. "Shiqi, go back. Just consider it helping me—don't let me feel more guilt."

Baili Shiqi bit her cherry-red lips and lowered her eyelids grievously.

"Alright, I'll listen to Sister Ning." After saying this, she raised her face again. "But I'll come looking for you again in the future!"

"If there's a chance, I hope we can meet again in the martial world." Ning Fuyi extended her hand toward her, and a pearl that had fallen from a 璎珞² glittered in her palm.

Baili Shiqi smiled and nodded vigorously, high-fiving her, then reluctantly turned around, spread her arms, and leaped into the sky.

She left with the wind.

"From now on, I'll have to spend the rest of my life with you in this barren ghostly place." Nine Infants placed her hand over her heart, making an expression as if she were about to cry.

Ning Fuyi was used to her sharp tongue and didn't respond. Instead, she took out the deep-sea glass cup and was surprised to find that the little sprout seemed somewhat withered, burying its head in the soil with its back to Ning Fuyi.

She reached out to poke the little sprout, and it shook off her finger forcefully, continuing to bury its head in the soil.

"Nine Infants, what's wrong with it? Haven't I cried enough these past few days? Is it about to dry up?" Ning Fuyi immediately panicked and was about to squeeze out tears, but Nine Infants pressed her hand down.

"You've cried more than enough—if you cry any more, your eyes will go blind!" Nine Infants lowered her head to examine the little sprout. "I can see its leaf veins are clear and its flesh is plump with water. It doesn't look like it lacks water."

After looking for a while, she suddenly understood something, and the corners of her mouth involuntarily stretched to her ears as she straightened up with a pretense of seriousness.

"Although this sprout doesn't have the Divine Venerable's memories, it still retains some habits from when it was the Divine Venerable." Nine Infants pursed her lips and smiled mischievously. "It saw another girl say she likes you and got angry."

"Ah." Ning Fuyi opened her mouth, heat rising beneath her eyes. "But Baili Shiqi definitely didn't mean it that way..."

"Don't tell me—tell it." Nine Infants pretended to fan herself and swayed gracefully as she walked into the distance. "I'm going to look for the entrance to the Demon Realm."

Ning Fuyi held the glass cup and looked at the little sprout that was still sulking with its stem turned away. Not knowing what to do, she finally lowered her head and touched the cool, tender bud with her lips.

The little sprout visibly stopped moving, then slowly straightened up, rustling in the wind.

As it swayed, a small tender bud suddenly sprouted from the pale green stem, like a shy bud waiting to bloom.

Ning Fuyi couldn't help but laugh out loud. She sighed long and carefully held the glass cup in her arms.

"Chu Qingqiu."

"When will you come back?"

For Ning Fuyi, entering the Demon Realm was like coming home. She opened the entrance to the Demon Realm with almost no effort and led Nine Infants into that land full of filthy and turbid qi.

"My goodness, this is the legendary Demon Realm?" Nine Infants clung to Ning Fuyi's sleeve and followed closely behind her step by step. "It's pitch black everywhere—even scarier than Ghost Eye."

"Although it's somewhat chaotic here, most demons and monsters are rational, unlike those in Ghost Eye who are all madmen." Ning Fuyi stepped on a ground of withered bones as she walked deeper.

Countless tall, stacked rocks stood like forests, the sky overhead perpetually covered by dark clouds. Occasionally, clusters of demonic qi would fly overhead, and from time to time, the roars of demonic beasts would echo, the sounds disappearing behind the endless chaotic rocks.

She still remembered the direction of the Demon Cave. It had originally been a place of ruins, the palace residence from when Jun Molan³ was still alive. Later, she had renovated it for her own use.

After an incense stick's worth of time, they found the place. After Jun Molan's death, no one dared approach this area, so it was still a ruin. Ning Fuyi raised her hand to move aside the rubble blocking the way and bent down to enter the palace.

"This place is quite large. How are you so familiar with it?" Nine Infants ran a few quick steps in surprise, picking up several dusty weapons and waving them around. "It's a pity the decoration is all so old—it would be quite troublesome to clean up."

"You don't need to clean it." As Ning Fuyi spoke, she drew a formation in the dust all over the ground. Pink light flashed as she summoned a group of little flower fairies⁴ wearing colorful wings.

"If you would." Ning Fuyi said, and those flower fairies fluttered their wings and scattered, beginning to diligently sweep spider webs and sand, polishing the dusty night pearls.

It had to be said that these little flower fairies were much more useful than lonely ghosts. Otherwise, in her previous life, she could only summon lonely ghosts, and rather than cleaning, they would create a floor full of blood and gore in an instant.

Nine Infants was happily watching the little flower fairies clean when her dark eyebrows suddenly stood up, and she said in a low voice: "Someone's coming."

"They should come." Ning Fuyi curved her lips, cold light flashing in her phoenix eyes. Then her figure transformed into a swift wind and rushed out of the great hall, raising her hand to summon heavenly thunder. The crackling lightning struck the newcomer right through, and that person immediately turned into demonic qi and scattered in the wind.

The other demons saw this and stopped in horror, looking at each other. Finally, a black-robed figure wrapped from head to toe spoke in a hoarse voice: "You're from the immortal sects. Instead of staying in your immortal realm, what do you mean by running to our Demon Realm!"

"I have no other intentions. I'm merely being rejected and pursued by the immortal clans, seeking a place to settle down and make a living." The woman with cold eyes and brows floated high in the air, her black dress brilliant. "If you don't harm me, I naturally won't hurt you either."

"Nonsense! Your immortal realm is full of tricks and has cleansed our demon clan's masses several times. You still want us to take you in—dream on!" The black-robed figure raised the long spike in his hand and charged forward with a great shout.

Ning Fuyi leaned back slightly to dodge his black qi, then spun in place, pink light bursting from her palms, sending him flying a full zhang⁵ away without even messing up a single strand of her hair.

"Immortal sect dog!" Another person charged up, their demonic weapon aimed at Ning Fuyi's heart and lungs, clearly intending to kill her. Ning Fuyi was just lacking someone to make an example of, so she no longer held back. She raised the Emei Thorns⁶ with her right hand and called forth thunder.

After the rumbling sound, lightning flashed across the sky. A bolt of heavenly thunder followed the Emei Thorns out of the clouds and instantly turned that person to ash.

The remaining people were immediately dumbfounded and didn't dare move: "This, this is the Emei Thorns?"

"The Emei Thorns of our ancestor Jun Molan?"

Ning Fuyi still stood in the light. She slowly lowered her hand, deliberately letting the electric-charged Emei Thorns appear before their eyes.

"Correct. These are Jun Molan's Emei Thorns. They have already recognized me as master, so you should know I'm not some immortal sect member." Ning Fuyi's phoenix eyes lowered as she looked down at the several people from above, like a fallen Buddha from hell, making the several demons feel chilled to the bone.

"Today I will stay here. If anyone is dissatisfied, feel free to come fight me. If you win, I'll leave. If you lose, you die." She smiled, her lip corners like blade edges, without a trace of kindness.

As soon as she finished speaking, another bolt of heavenly thunder shattered the stone mountain. The earth-shaking sound scared the demons into retreating, looking around anxiously.

"Furthermore, I know the Demon Realm is ruled by the strong with hundreds of factions flourishing, and many suffer hardships. So today I settle here, and anyone who wants to follow me may enter this Demon Cave. Whether you're demon or monster, I will shelter you all, ensuring your lifetime of peace without being bullied." Her voice echoed between heaven and earth, attracting more demons who watched cautiously.

The crowd was silent. Finally, the black-robed figure who had first stepped forward walked steadily forward and said: "If you want us to follow you, you should at least tell us who you are?"

"You don't need to know who I am, and I won't use my former name again." Ning Fuyi slowly descended, standing with her hands behind her back. The appearance she had at Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate quietly faded away, leaving only stunningly sharp features and an aura full of evil.

She said softly: "From now on, you need only call me by one title—Demon Lord."

Footnotes

- ¹ **Moon cakes** - Traditional pastries eaten during the Mid-Autumn Festival, symbolizing reunion and completeness
- ² **璎珞 (Yingluo)** - A type of traditional Chinese jewelry, often beaded necklaces or ornamental chains
- ³ **Jun Molan** - The previous Demon Lord who was defeated and killed earlier in the story
- ⁴ **Little flower fairies** - Small magical beings that can help with cleaning and other tasks
- ⁵ **Zhang** - A traditional Chinese unit of measurement, approximately 3.3 meters or 10 feet
- ⁶ **Emei Thorns** - A weapon that was previously owned by Jun Molan, now serves as Ning Fuyi's primary demonic weapon